

technique that will finally allow him to reveal the truth that will elude Thompson and all the others.

A good deal of the movie's artistic success can be attributed to Welles's experience of working in theater. *Citizen Kane* is a movie that not only uses temporal devices in the narrative, but spatial ones, too, so that it can sometimes almost seem like a 3D movie. In a crucial early scene, Thompson discovers how Kane was born to a poor family who discovered gold on their land and, as part of a business deal, handed the boy over to a wealthy guardian. As the bargain is made in the foreground, we see the young

Leland (Joseph Cotten) speaks at Kane's political rally. Ultimately the campaign, and their friendship, will be derailed by Kane's obsessive affair.

Kane through the window, playing in the snow, oblivious. It is a simple perspective trick imported from theater, and it is used to capture the tragedy that befalls Kane. It is the moment in which the life he should have led ends.

Innovative shots

Welles and cameraman Gregg Toland employed such spatial devices throughout the movie, a feat achieved with deep-focus lenses and camera angles so low that Kane may appear, variously, as a titan and as a gangster. This in itself was a novelty, since prior to *Citizen Kane* filmmakers rarely used such upward shots, for the simple reason that few studios had ceilings due to the lighting and sound equipment. ("A big lie in order to get all those terrible lights up there," said

Welles.) Yet Welles took his camera so far down that, for a scene in which Kane talks with his friend Leland after losing his first election, a hole had to be dug in the concrete studio floor.

Toland's input is a vital part of *Citizen Kane*'s legacy, since, although it would seal Welles's status as one of America's first auteur directors, this was very much a collaborative effort. Also vital was the risk Welles took with his cast and production team—for whom *Citizen Kane* launched their careers in movies. Many of the actors were unknown to audiences—they came from Welles's Mercury Theatre group. His editor, Robert Wise, would soon begin a successful directing career of his own; and the score marked a debut for Bernard Herrmann, later to form an

